The Sense of Her

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra)

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POV Catra (She-Ra), Coming of Age, Canon Universe, War, Hiding, Training, Injury, Wound Tending, Drinking, Making Up, Morning Kisses, Suggestive Themes, Cuddling & Snuggling, Friends to Enemies to Lovers

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The Sense of Her

by SimplyAbsolute

Summary

There was something about Adora that always put her senses on high alert no matter the situation. She was attuned to her in every way, constantly seeking her out anytime they were in proximity to one another.

She could never keep her eyes off her, she attentively listened to every noise she made, she could taste the bitterness on her tongue as she shouted at her, she found comfort in her scent like no other, she could feel every quiver of her body under her hands…

She couldn't ignore anything about her even if she tried.

It was simply impossible.

5 + 1 highlighting each of Catra's five senses independently, plus a bonus involving all of them at once.

Notes

Guys... you don't even want to know how long this has been sitting in my drafts for. Let's just say it's an embarrassing amount of time. Sorry, if this shares any similarities with my other 5+1 (I technically wrote them around the same time, though I think this one was drafted first...) ANYWAY my yearly burst of inspiration has finally stuck so here is ~this~ and be on the look out for some other stuff in the future 😊 Catradora still possesses me, what can I say?

See the end of the work for more notes

4 years old, Gates of the Fright Zone, 8:39pm

Run .

All Catra could do was run as far away from the fires, screaming and explosions as her little legs could take her. Her muscles ached and her lungs burned with every pant as she tried to maintain her pace even through the heavy downpour of rain that had started minutes ago.

She didn't know where she was running too, but she knew she had to be far enough away by now. The terrain was unfamiliar, foreign… nothing insight except dull metal, bright lights, and towering structures. If she wasn't completely exhausted and numb from what she had already seen, she may have been intimidated. But now, she doesn't really know what to feel anymore...

A clap of thunder rang through the air and her fur would've been standing on end if it wasn't already weighed down by rain and mud. She needed to find somewhere to hide and shelter from the elements until the storm passed. Then she could figure out where she was and what to do next.

Catra scanned the area and saw a stack of small boxes and crates nearby and she quickly made her way over to them. She opted to crawl into one that was lying on its side even as it began to sag under its own soggy weight. Once she was inside, she pulled on the flaps, to close them as much as possible, and curled in on herself.

Her world became nothing more than a cold, dark, damp cardboard box no bigger than a couple feet.

Shivers wracked her small frame.

She wanted to cry but she had to stay strong for herself and for her family…

Catra thought about all the stories that her Mama always used to tell her. She said that there would be a day when bad people found them. People who wanted to destroy their homes and take their lands for themselves. Evil people who sought nothing but destruction and glory for themselves. Monsters that would break them apart and change their lives forever…

She thought the stories were fake, tales told to scare the Magicats of the outside world, but it seemed that today, those nightmares became her reality. Catra remembered the most important part of those stories as she ran though, and that was to find somewhere safe to hide… which led her to where she was now.

All she needed to do now was wait.

They would find her soon… right?

But I didn't see anyone else on my way out… And I don't know what happened or where I am… She blinked water from her eyes. *What if Mama can't find me after the fires and storms pass...*

Catra was spooked from her thoughts when she heard rustling, followed by several loud thumps approaching from outside the box she was tucked away in. Without much warning she was blinded by light flooding her vision now that the side flaps were open. She immediately closed her eyes and hissed in response, clawing at anything she could land her hands on.

"No. *No*! Get away from me!"

She swiped wildly through the air for several seconds until she felt something warm and giving beneath the tips of her claws, followed by a yelp and soft whimper. A sound that was something far softer than one of those people that had attacked her home let out. They all growled and yelled, but this sound was quiet and small.

She cracked open her eyes to find bright blue ones staring back at her.

“Ow…” The girl rubbed at her cheek before she seemed to realize somebody was looking at her. “Oh, hi! One of the older cadets told me they saw something running around over here and sent me to go check it out and I guess it was you! Are you okay?!" She dropped her hand.

Who was this girl? Wait...

Catra looked at the scratch she had left. "I guess, but wait… I'm the one that hurt you!"

"It's okay, you were just scared." She smiled. It was far too warm for a place like this.

"I am not scared!" *She was terrified.*

“A lot of the kids are when they first get here…” The girl continued, completely disregarding her outburst. “But then they realize it’s not that bad! Plus, we’re safe from the princesses here.”

“The princesses?”

The girl gasped. “You don’t know about the princesses?!”

“...No?” They must’ve been the ones who attacked her home. *Her family.*

“It’s a good thing you’re here then…” She paused. “What is your name?”

For some reason she felt like she could trust her. “...Catra.”

"Catra..." She said, like she was testing out the name. "That's so pretty! I’m Adora."

Adora. That’s a nice name too. Catra thought. She had never heard of that one before.

“Well, don’t you worry Catra! I’ll protect you from those evil princesses!” She scowled and raised a small fist into the air.

The sight managed to make her laugh slightly even after everything that happened today. “Thanks.”

"You're welcome!" She took a hold of Catra’s wrist before she could protest. "Now come on! Let's get you dried off and something to eat! I bet you're starving!” She paused. “Hm… dinner is probably over by now, but I have a few gray ration bars hidden in my bunk that I know you’ll like!” She continued with a giggle. “...but don’t tell anyone.”

Catra let herself be dragged through the halls of this unfamiliar place by a girl that offered her the only bit of warmth and comfort that seemed to be there. She could figure out everything in the morning, for now she would stay here with her.

***15 years old, Fright Zone Training Arena* , 1:27pm**

Adora was starting to get noticed more and Catra didn’t like that at all, even though she managed to hide it well. As Adora’s stats got better, and her body grew taller and stronger, so did her popularity. Everyone wanted to be friends with the *golden child*, the *natural born leader*… she was someone they knew would never let them down.

But in the back of her mind, Catra knew that Adora was her best friend and didn’t have anything to worry about. Still, that didn’t mean that she didn’t get a little out of hand sometimes. Especially when people were obviously just using her kindness to up their own rank and Adora was completely oblivious to it…

At times she was grateful to have drills to run because it allowed her to let off some steam and this was definitely one of those

days that she needed it.

Today they were currently running a basic battle formation under the supervision of some random force captain they've never seen before, grateful that they were not being hovered over by Shadow Weaver for once.

Catra surveyed the arena. There were three bots on the field. One was taken out within the first minute of the simulation, one being taken on by Kyle, Rogelio and Lonnie, and the other being fought single handedly by Adora. Because of course Adora was stubborn enough to try and take on a bot one versus one, while her other teammates were nowhere close to her.

She sighed and hoped off her perch. It was her time to shine.

When it came to taking down bots, Catra's stats were above average, if not excellent. She had the speed, the stealth and *claws* that helped her overcome such a large foe. Unlike Adora who was slow on her feet and focused more on defense than actively destroying the opponent.

She casually sauntered up to Adora's side as she grunted from exertion.

"Hey, Adora."

"Catra!" She whipped her head to the side with wide eyes. "Where have you been?!"

"Aw, what did you miss me or something?"

She scoffed. "Just help me take this thing down!"

"So demanding." She teased, earning an eye roll from the latter. "But, fine."

Catra lunged underneath the bot, swiping low at its belly where it was most vulnerable and listened to the telltale sign of her claws cutting through the metal. She skidded to a stop on the other side

and leapt to plant herself on top of it and began to rip out the electronics from one of the projection windows.

After a few moments the bot was down, just before the arena alarm sounded and Catra couldn’t be happier. She jumped off the bot with a smile on her face and walked to the front where she had left Adora seconds ago...

"Haha! That was amazing!" She said through a series of giggles. “What were you even doing, Adora? Nothing?”

And then she spotted her. Adora was on the ground, clutching her left wrist, purpling skin beginning to bloom under her fingertips, and there were tears in her eyes.

A million thoughts rushed through her mind as she rushed to her side. "No no no Adora! What happened?! You can’t be hurt!” She paused. “Shadow Weaver is going to kill me..."

Adora sniffed. "The bot swiped at me… and I might have tried to hit it back, just before you took it down, but it's fine, just a bruise." She removed the vice grip from her wrist. I was already swollen and there were definitely bumps in places there shouldn’t be. They both cringed. "Okay, maybe it's a little bit more than a bruise."

"Gods Adora! You're such an idiot!” Catra helped her off the ground. “Why were you trying to fight a bot by yourself anyway?!"

"...Because you can.” She said just above a whisper.

“Adora… you can’t do everything I can… just like I can’t do everything you can.”

She opened her mouth to reply but they were interrupted by the force captain calling out to them. “You two! What are you doing?! Get back in line!”

Shit. “Uh, okay! Just give us a second to uh… go to the bathroom?” She looked at Adora who nodded to confirm. “Yeah, the bathroom. We’ll be right back!”

“Make it quick cadets!”

“Yes, sir!” Adora replied as they were walking, more like lightly jogging, to the locker room.

They chose to settle down on one of the benches and Adora held out her arm for Catra to examine. They’ve been here before, usually Catra was the one getting hurt, but they knew enough about this kind of thing that going to the infirmary wasn’t necessary. Plus, it was less of a risk of Shadow Weaver finding out this way too.

Catra took Adora’s arm in one hand and pressed lightly along the most swollen areas of her wrist with the other. Her ears flicked forward every time Adora breathed in too quickly through her nose or failed to hide a grunt from the pain.

"Good news is that I don't think it's broken? But it's definitely dislocated and we're probably going to have to fix this ourselves..."

"Catra... I can't." Adora said breathlessly.

She looked up at her. Surprised by the change of tone. "But you can... you're the strongest person I know" Catra smoothed her thumb over the back of Adora’s hand and smiled. "And if you’re strong enough to think you can take on a bot by yourself, then you can withstand me fixing your dislocated wrist."

“Maybe you're right…” Adora smiled back at her.

“Of course, I’m right. When am I ever wrong?”

“Uh, like all the time?”

She lightly shoved her through a laugh. “Shut up!”

“No, you!” Adora pushed back with her good hand.

“Okay, okay… before either of us get any more injured--”

“Since when did you become the voice of reason?” She interrupted.

Catra glared at her before she continued. “Are you ready?”

Adora exhaled. “As ready as I’ll ever be.”

“Okay, bite down on this towel if you need to.”

“Okay.”

Catra adjusted their hands so she was holding it in the same position she would give someone a handshake in. Adora’s palm was hot and clammy in hers. *She must be really nervous… I am too*. Catra then braced her other hand on Adora's left wrist as lightly as possible so as to not inflict any more pain or damage but enough to get a good hold. She looked at Adora one more time, and once she received a nod from her, she began to pull.

Immediately Catra winced at the pained yelp Adora released before she remembered to bite down on the cloth they had found. She pulled harder until she heard an audible pop and then released her grip slowly, but still kept her hand in hers. Adora spit out the towel and swiped at her eyes to clear away a stray tear that had escaped before Catra could get to it.

“Better?” She lightly touched the bruised area again.

Adora flexed her wrist as best as she could. “Better.”

“Let’s get your wrist wrapped up and get back out there before then send someone in here...”

They quickly finished their impromptu first-aid session and got back out on the floor. The rest of the day went without a hitch and the swelling and bruising in Adora’s wrist got better

throughout the week. Catra helped in any way she could, and she was grateful Adora let her. It was kind of their thing.

As long as they were together to take care of one another, nothing could go wrong...

---

19 years old, The Crimson Waste, 3:15pm

The alcohol burned an inordinate amount on the way down her throat, but she didn't care. The mighty all-powerful *She-Ra* was bound in a makeshift holding cell down the hall of what used to be her predecessor's ship. Gagged and silenced as Catra took away the only thing that gave her power.

An ironic fate if you asked her…

Said object of power was currently leaned up against the wall across from her. It shined ethereally bright even in the darkened hallway she stood in. She felt herself frown before she took another swig of her drink, keeping her eyes locked on it over the brim of her cup. This *thing*, this cursed sword, changed both of their lives forever. It stole Adora from her, it ruined *everything*.

She shook her head to clear her thoughts. Once the sword was brought back in the Fright Zone, everything would finally go back to normal. The sword would be destroyed if Entrapta's project was successful, She-Ra would be *gone*, the war would be won, and Adora…. being the traitor that she was… well, the best outcome she could get was the rest of her life in a prison cell, and the worst outcome…

Catra growled to herself, denting her cup under the force of her hand clenched around it. She shouldn't *care* about her anymore. Obviously Adora doesn't so why should she? Still, the thought of

Adora de– *not here anymore*, made bile bubble up at the back of her throat.

She easily blamed the feeling on her drink. She was unused to having any sort of alcohol but was convinced to join in on the festivities as soon as they started. *Why not?* She asked herself. She was curious and wanted to try it, everyone else seemed to be having fun. So why wasn't she…

She finished the last gulp in her cup, before tossing it aside.

Adora didn't mean anything to her anymore.

She didn't care what happened to her.

She was finally going to *win*.

The idea of imminent success sat heavy on her tongue as she took the sword in her hand, walking back towards the main room where she could still hear the party raging. She had a victory speech that needed to be said, even as her mouth watered and her stomach clenched painfully with every step she took. She pushed forward, just like she always had, and let herself bask in people finally celebrating her and her achievements.

The underlying heaviness of it all pushed to the back of her mouth and swallowed along with its bitter metallic taste, to make way for glory and triumph.

…

…

Little did she know that this path would leave her with no victory, just even more years of fighting, and end with her choking on the taste of acidic green liquid, her mind no longer her own to control, brutally fighting against the one she vowed never to hurt, until everything came crashing down and her world turned into complete nothingness…

---

21 years old, Mara's Spaceship, Time Unknown

She awoke slowly, feeling like each piece of her body was gradually coming back to life. Her body no longer ached, as if she had just broken every bone in her body instantaneously. Instead, she was left warm, comfortable and relaxed.

She twitched her fingers as they came back under her control, moving them along soft fabric under her hands. Her claws snagged against it, but she managed to adjust herself so that she could snuggle more fully down into the warmth that surrounded her.

She breathed in deep letting a wonderful scent fill her lungs. She can't place it at this moment, brain still a little clouded, but she knew it brought her a comfort she hadn't felt in years, making her body relaxed even further.

Catra nuzzled down into the scent, she wanted to get as close to it as possible, nosing along the fabric for the source of it. Her ears pricked forward at a sound above her. A soft giggle, before she was slightly repositioned, her face lifted up to skin, *her* scent completely overwhelming her nose, but still her body sagged in relief.

Catra did not open her eyes, and she refused to do so now.

Her mind might still be a little foggy, but she was not delusional. She knew who was holding her now. If the scent didn't give her away once she had placed it, the giggle certainly would have. She didn't want to shatter the dream. She was still not a hundred percent certain that this wasn't a dream…

They stayed like that for an unknown amount of time, while Catra just basked in the unfamiliar familiarity of it all. She thought she

would never experience this again…

Without warning she was jostled from her space, the body under her shifting to reach for something in the distance. The movement caused Catra to be disrupted from her position near her neck. She whimpered at the loss of her skin no longer under her nose.

"Shhh, you're okay," a familiar voice said from above her, as what felt like a blanket settled around them, "I'm not going anywhere."

And for the first time in a long time Catra actually believed it.

---

24 years old, ~~Adora's~~ Their Room in Bright Moon, 7:23am

There was something about Bright Moon that brought a certain level of softness to everything that inhabited it. From the sunlight flickering in through the curtain, gently illuminating the room, to their bed and blankets, so plush that it felt like a warm hug every time you crawled into it. To the sleepy expression on her lover's face that made Catra smile to no end, nothing could ever feel as delicate and precious as this moment. She sometimes couldn't believe that a world like this was real, especially when she gazed upon the sleeping woman next to her.

Waking up to Adora felt like a gift from the gods every morning. It felt like something sacred, something no one should be able to see. Yet here Catra was the only one to witness the sanctity of this moment, with an undeniable amount of affection and love in her heart.

She reached up to run her fingers through Adora's golden hair and received a contented sigh in response. Sometimes she still couldn't believe that any of this was real. How did they go from two kids trying to survive, to fighting a war on opposite sides, to

defeating an intergalactic dictator and saving the universe, to this?

It had been a few years now since the end of the world, but it sometimes still feels a bit unbelievable, especially when she got to wake up to this every morning. The love of her life beside her, snoring softly, in the safety of their room. Her heart felt like it was bursting.

She moved her hand down, brushing her fingertips along the line of Adora's jaw and neck, pausing to admire the bruises from the bites she left there last night. She continued her movements, stroking down her right arm, cherishing the details of Adora's skin as she went. New and old scars, with the occasional freckle dotting her flesh, not unlike the ones on Catra's cheeks.

She felt Adora shift next to her, the arm under her fingers twitching slightly before she moved her gaze back up to Adora's face. Blue eyes met hers instantly and Catra couldn't help but smile.

She squeezed Adora's hand. "Good morning, beautiful," she greeted before crawling closer to her on the bed.

Adora blushed, "good morning," she replied sleepily, "what were you doing?"

"Just appreciating what I get to wake up to every morning," she said pointedly reaching for the covers and sliding them further down.

"You're ridiculous."

"Mm, no, don't think I am." She swept her hand down the planes of Adora's stomach and over the curve of her hip. Smiling when she felt her muscles tense. "I mean, have you seen yourself?"

She still couldn't believe that she got to touch her freely like that and that Adora responded to her touch like this. Despite last night's *activities*, she could feel herself getting wound up again

just from having her hands on Adora's bare body and having her react this way to her gentle touches.

Adora huffed, "have you seen *you*?"

Instead of replying, Catra lightly ran her nails up Adora's side causing her to shudder beneath her fingertips. She smiled to herself, repeating the motion on Adora's other side and watching how pink lines bloom over quivering skin.

"*Catra*…"

She glanced up and took in the delightful flush across Adora's cheeks, which was quickly sweeping *down*. She brought her hand back up, backing off and opting to return stroking through Adora's hair instead of along her body. Hoping to settle the heat that was surely building between them. Not that she minded the direction that things were going in, but…

"Yes, my love?" She responded innocently.

Adora gave her a blank look, "you can't just do that and then not…"

Take care of me . Oh, so she wanted to continue too? That was probably Catra's fault for waking her up the way she did, but oh well, too bad she fell in love with the most difficult person in the universe. Catra suspected that was just another thing Adora loved about her though.

"And not… *what*?" She leaned over her, almost close enough for their noses to touch, hands sweeping back down her body. "Do you need something, princess?"

Adora gasped under her, "...you know what I need."

"You're going to have to tell me, otherwise…" she made a move like she was going to get out of bed, "it's about time we get dressed for the day, don't you think?"

Before she could even move a couple feet away from her, Adora had their positions flipped, staring down at her with hungry eyes. Catra's fur fluffed up as her tail lashed across their sheets. She didn't think she worked her girlfriend up this much, but she guessed she was wrong. Still, she not complaining by any means.

"I need you," Adora breathed out before she descended upon her with a needy kiss, Catra meeting her with equal vigor.

Afterall, who was Catra to deny her of anything? They deserved it, especially after everything they'd been through.

***31 years old, Bright Moon Infirmary* , 11:23am**

Catra knew she had to look like an absolute mess. Her hair was plastered against the sweat on her forehead, dry tear stains streaked across her cheeks, and her exhausted body was practically half-naked… But as a faint rumbling, that matched her own, reverberated throughout her chest, she knew that everything she had been through in life was worth it in this moment.

Catra never remembered *seeing* anyone like her, no one had ever *felt* like her. The baby cradled in her arms had fur like her, stripes like her, nails and teeth like her… The only thing that was different about them was their golden mane, at least that was what she had thought until the baby blinked open their eyes to the world for the first time and she was met with their incredible turquoise gaze.

She gasped, "*Adora*."

"I know. I see," her voice wavered as she leaned over the bed Catra was laying in for a better view.

Their kitten was so small and yet already their entire world. They held onto Catra's finger like she was their entire world too and suddenly she felt herself welling up again. She really was a mess right now, but Adora, the attentive wife that she was, stroked through Catra's hair to soothe her, choosing to pay as much attention to her as their baby.

Finn chose that moment to wriggle around a bit, kicking out their little legs and scrunching up their face, before settling against Catra's chest again. She heard Adora cooing beside her, reaching out to pet along their child's head too.

"They're so cute. I can't believe we made *that*."

Catra laughed softly, "you mean, *I* made that."

Adora turned to look at her with a raised eyebrow, "okay, fine you did most of the work, but technically…."

"No, no but I don't want to hear it right now. You didn't just push a child out of you."

Her wife raised her hands in false surrender. "Okay, okay fine," she said through a smile.

Catra smiled back, returning to purring happily in tune with the baby against her chest. She affectionately licked against their forehead, making what little hair they did have stand on end, before nuzzling against them. They smelled *incredible*. She knew baby smell was a thing but having something that smelled exactly like a mix of Adora and herself, but entirely individual to their kitten, was already driving her maternal instincts up the wall.

She felt them wriggling against her again letting out a sad *mew* as they sniffed at the air towards Adora's hand, and Catra felt her heart clench at the sight and sound.

"I think they want you closer too," she looked up at Adora a little desperately.

Without hesitation, her wife began to climb into the bed and Catra couldn't help but giggle.

“I am pretty sure you’re not allowed to do that.”

“How else am I supposed to get closer?”

Catra shrugged and scooted over so Adora could slide into the small bed next to her. Finn immediately calmed again as Adora wrapped Catra in her arms so that she was lying against her wife’s chest along with their new baby. She kept a hand on Finn and Adora as she felt herself beginning to drift off, the exhaustion of the day finally catching up to her.

She felt Adora brush the bangs from her face. “You can sleep, my love, I’ll be right here. Finny too.”

“You promise?”

“I promise,” her wife responded with a kiss against the crown of her head.

Catra smiled, nuzzling down into the warmth and safety of her wife's arms.

As she drifted off, calmed by Adora wrapped around her and the rumbling of the baby in her arms, she thought about how unbelievable this moment was. Over twenty years ago, she was just some stray in a box who was lucky enough she became the object of affection of the most incredible girl she had ever met.

They had their difficult moments, sure, (and yes, she knew that was an understatement) but things turned out alright in the end. The universe brought them together again, and she couldn’t wait to see what else life had instore for them.

With the two of them by her side, she knew everything would be okay. They could handle whatever the universe threw at them next.

Together. Forever and always.

End Notes

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